CONDENSED BRIEF

JAKARTA VS MANILA FIRST RESEARCH

Culture, people and money: what Paul's first research says for CORSA in Jakarta, and what to check next



For Samuel Leu, CORSA. HSG Capstone x CORSA. Research by Paul Berkmann; redesign by Tiago Reimann, 9 October 2026.
Redesigned from 'First research' (Hofstede dimensions, Jakarta and Manila figures, World Bank data on Indonesia).

Big market, open cultural risk, squeezed wallets

WHY WE LOOKED The kickoff asked the team to challenge Jakarta with evidence [8], and Meeting 4 asked whether collectivism is a threat or an advantage [9].

THE DATA Paul's first research (6 Oct 2026): Hofstede scores, a Jakarta vs Manila table, BPS (Statistics Indonesia) age data for Jakarta city and World Bank figures. Most economic figures are national, not Jakarta; no CORSA customer asked yet.

5 vs 79
individualism, Indonesia vs Switzerland (Hofstede index, 0 to 100) [1]

-1.45%
a year: Jakarta city residents aged 20 to 39, 2021 to 2026, projected [3]

-2.3%
a year: real wages of high-skilled workers in Indonesia, 2018 to 2024 [5]

27%
of Indonesian households call themselves poor (Aug 2025), up 7 pp (percentage points) [5]

FIVE TAKEAWAYS [1, 3, 5, 6]

01 Culture: collective and hierarchical; the rice norm is the open risk for pasta.

02 People: Jakarta city is **5.6x** Manila's core, but its young adults shrink.

03 Manila's core grows faster: **0.72%** (2020 to 2024) vs **0.32%** (2020 to 2025).

04 Money: Indonesia's economy grew **5.0%** (2025, first three quarters); skilled real wages fall.

05 Digital: **87.8%** of Jakartans are online, against **72.8%** nationally.

WHAT CORSA SHOULD DO

1 Test how wheat pasta sits against the rice norm before menu decisions.

2 Plan staff roles and training for high power distance.

3 Price for skilled professionals whose real wages are falling.

4 Decide Manila's role: finish the comparison or keep it as a benchmark.

How to read this. Each page: why we looked, the data, meaning, next. Conclusion: page 7; sources [n]: page 8.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR CORSA

- **Jakarta is large enough; cultural fit and price are the open questions.**
- **The rice norm and falling skilled wages touch the core product and the price.**
- **Manila cannot be judged yet: most comparison cells are empty; its role is not decided.**

HOW TO CONTINUE

a Split the desk work using the ranking and gaps on page 6.

b Close the desk gaps before the interim presentation on 22 October 2026.

c Ask for a deeper dive on one page first.

Note. Desk research only; national figures stand in where Jakarta data is missing. Ranking, means and next steps are this brief's view, not findings of the research.

Collective and hierarchical: test the rice norm

WHY WE LOOKED Meeting 4 asked whether Indonesia's collectivism is a threat or an advantage [9], and the scope asks whether the brand transfers culturally.

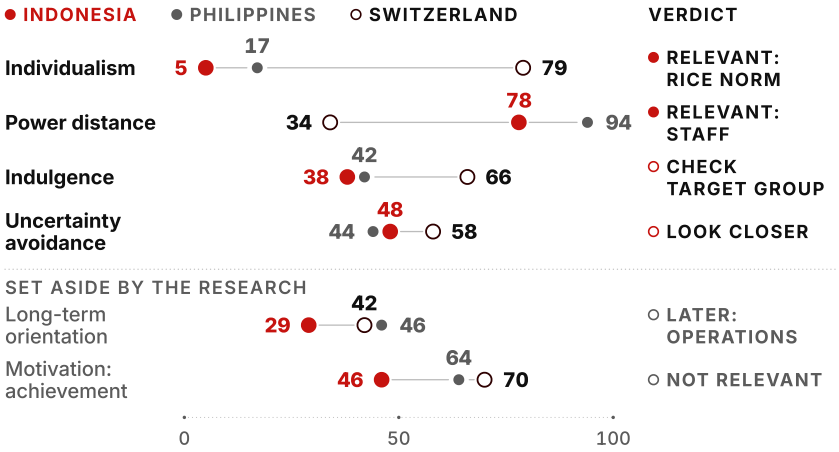
THE DATA Hofstede's cultural dimensions (Hofstede, 1991 [2]); scores 0 to 100 from The Culture Factor [1], with Paul's note per dimension (6 Oct 2026). Scores are national averages, not Jakarta customers; the Philippines and Switzerland are for comparison only.

5/17/79
individualism: Indonesia / Philippines / Switzerland (0 to 100) [1]

78/94/34
power distance: Indonesia / Philippines / Switzerland [1]

12.2%
rice share of Indonesia's food and beverages basket [5]

38
indulgence, Indonesia (Switzerland 66) [1]



RESEARCH VERDICT: ● RELEVANT ○ CHECK ○ SET ASIDE

Hofstede scores 0 to 100, Indonesia / Philippines / Switzerland: power distance 78 / 94 / 34; individualism 5 / 17 / 79; motivation towards achievement and success 46 / 64 / 70; uncertainty avoidance 48 / 44 / 58; long-term orientation 29 / 46 / 42; indulgence 38 / 42 / 66 [1].

WHAT MATTERS FOR CUSTOMERS [1]

- Individualism: Indonesia 5, Philippines 17, extremely collectivistic; group belonging and social norms matter.
- Rice culture: if wheat pasta breaks the norm, wheat-based sales may suffer.
- Indulgence 38, low: may hint at reluctance toward new culinary experiences.
- Uncertainty avoidance 48: may affect trying a new food; needs a closer look.

WHAT MATTERS FOR STAFF [1]

- Power distance 78: Southeast Asian cultures expect more inequality between superiors and staff.
- Employees will not question orders or superiors: key for structuring a branch.

SET ASIDE BY THE RESEARCH [1]

- Motivation (46): not relevant; drives neither customer decisions nor the staff profile.
- Long-term orientation 29, relatively low: no relevance yet (6 Oct 2026); maybe operations later.

NOT YET KNOWN [9]

- No Indonesian evidence yet on collectivism or how wheat pasta is seen (Paul's task).
- Whether the target group differs from the general population, for example on indulgence.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR CORSA

- **The rice norm is the biggest cultural risk to CORSA's core product.**
- **Hierarchy shapes training and store roles.**
- **Groups can be a sales channel (Jakarta customer brief, culture page).**

HOW TO CONTINUE

a. Find Indonesian data on wheat versus rice meals (Paul's open task).

b. FIELD WEEK, IF CONFIRMED Add a rice or grain base to the taste test; date open.

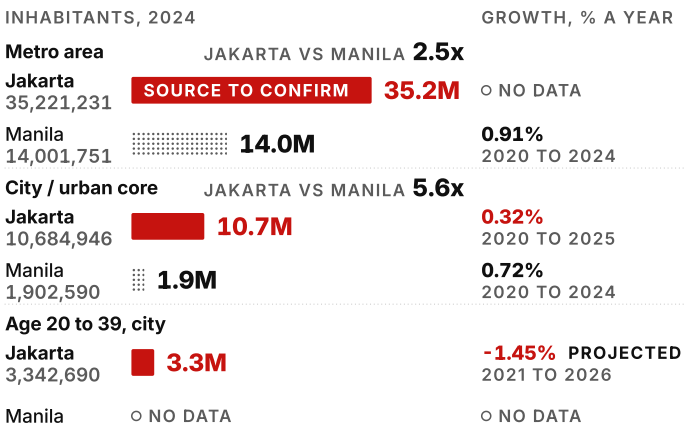
c. Map each relevant dimension to a CAGE (cultural, administrative, geographic, economic distance) question.

Note. Scores are national averages from The Culture Factor tool, not Jakarta customers; the Philippines and Switzerland are for comparison only.

Manila grows faster; most comparison cells are empty

WHY WE LOOKED At the kickoff Paul raised the Philippines as an alternative, and the scope lets the team challenge Jakarta with evidence [8].

THE DATA Paul's Jakarta vs Manila table, mostly 2024: BPS (Statistics Indonesia) for Jakarta city [3], PSA (Philippine Statistics Authority) for Manila [6]. The Jakarta metro figure has no source in the research; fertility values are national, not city.



Metro and city-core population, 2024, with yearly growth where the research has it [3, 6]; Jakarta metro source to confirm.

NOT YET KNOWN

- Empty or TBD in both cities: 6 of 14 rows.
- Manila: no figure for residents aged 20 to 39.

2.5x
more metro residents in Jakarta than Manila, 2024 (computed; Jakarta figure to confirm) [6]

5.6x
more residents in Jakarta city than in Manila's urban core, 2024 (computed) [3, 6]

0.72% vs 0.32%
city growth a year: Manila (2020 to 2024) vs Jakarta (2020 to 2025; source not stated) [6]

7 vs 5
of 14 comparison rows filled: Jakarta vs Manila (computed)

READ WITH CARE [4, 7]

- TFR values are national: Indonesia and the Philippines, not Jakarta or Manila.
- The research expects both countries below replacement rate by 2030.
- Jakarta metro figure: source not given in the research, to confirm.

THE RESEARCH'S 14 ROWS [3, 4, 5, 6, 7]

ROW (2024 UNLESS STATED)	JAKARTA	MANILA
Inhabitants, metropolitan area	35,221,231 (source to confirm)	14,001,751 [6]
Inhabitants, city or urban core	10,684,946 [3]	1,902,590 [6]
Aged 20 to 39, metropolitan area	○ MISSING	○ MISSING
Aged 20 to 39, city or urban core	3,342,690 [3]	○ MISSING
Population growth, metropolitan area	○ MISSING	**0.91%** a year, 2020 to 2024 [6]
Growth aged 20 to 39, metropolitan area	○ MISSING	○ MISSING
Population growth, city or urban core	**0.32%** a year, 2020 to 2025	**0.72%** a year, 2020 to 2024 [6]
Growth aged 20 to 39, city or urban core	**-1.45%** a year, 2021 to 2026, projected [3]	○ MISSING
Expected population growth	○ MISSING	○ MISSING
TFR (total fertility rate), national	Indonesia 2.01, year not given [4]	Philippines 1.82, year not given; 1.88 in 2025 [7]
HDI (Human Development Index)	○ MISSING	○ MISSING
Income development	Indonesia: negative real wage growth in high and middle skilled jobs, 2018 to 2024 [5]	○ MISSING
Opinion of western products and companies	○ MISSING	○ MISSING
Openness for western food	○ TBD (TO BE DETERMINED)	○ TBD (TO BE DETERMINED)

WHAT IT MEANS FOR CORSA

- **Jakarta is bigger; Manila grows faster. The table cannot decide anything yet.**
- **Paul's kickoff point that Filipinos love Western food has no data in the research yet.**

HOW TO CONTINUE

a. Fill the Manila column (PSA age tables, HDI, openness) before the interim presentation on 22 October 2026.

b. Keep Manila as one benchmark line next to Singapore, Dubai and Hong Kong, the scope's benchmarks.

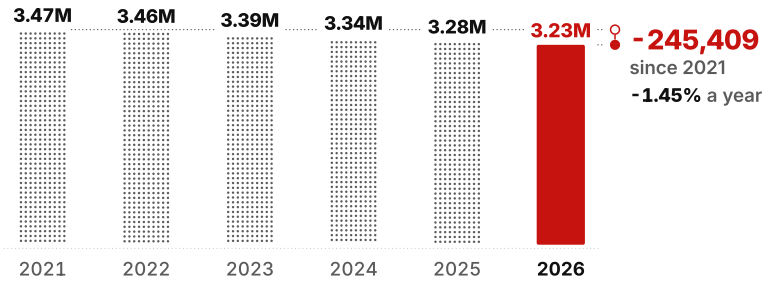
c. Drop Manila and focus on Jakarta.

Note. Manila's role is not decided. Fertility values are national (Statista [4, 7]). Jakarta's 0.32% city growth disagrees with the age spreadsheet's 0.047%: see page 4.

Fewer young adults in Jakarta each year

WHY WE LOOKED Scope question: do CORSA's target customers exist in sufficient concentration in Jakarta?

THE DATA BPS (Statistics Indonesia) population by age for Jakarta city (DKI Jakarta province), 2021 to 2026, compiled by Paul in a spreadsheet [3]. The research calls the trend projected; there is no metro (Greater Jakarta) age data yet.



AGED 20 TO 39, EXACT
3,470,539 3,455,198 3,390,869 3,342,690 3,283,359 3,225,130

TOTAL POPULATION (ALL AGES), +0.047% A YEAR ON AVERAGE
10,644,776 10,679,951 10,672,100 10,684,946 10,677,975 10,669,702

2021 TO 2026 TREND LABELLED PROJECTED IN THE RESEARCH

Jakarta city residents aged 20 to 39, 2021 to 2026: average -1.45% a year, projected [3]; -245,409 computed.

3.34M
Jakarta city residents aged 20 to 39 in 2024 (3,342,690) [3]

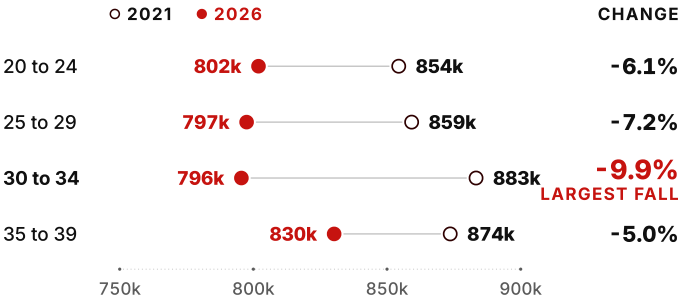
-245,409
residents aged 20 to 39, 2021 to 2026, projected (-7.1%, computed) [3]

30.2%
share of 20 to 39 year olds in 2026, from 32.6% in 2021 (computed) [3]

10.67M
total residents in 2026: flat, +0.047% a year since 2021 [3]

PRIME PROFESSIONAL AGE FALLS MOST [3]

- 30 to 34: -87,782 people (**-9.9%**) from 2021 to 2026, the largest fall.
- 25 to 29: **-7.2%**; 20 to 24: **-6.1%**; 35 to 39: **-5.0%**.



Change per age band, 2021 vs 2026, computed from [3]; 30 to 34 falls most.

TWO GROWTH FIGURES DISAGREE [3]

- Research table: Jakarta city **+0.32%** a year, 2020 to 2025.
- Age spreadsheet: **+0.047%** a year, 2021 to 2026; different periods, no match.

NOT YET KNOWN

- No age data yet for the metro (Greater Jakarta) area.

JAKARTA CITY BY AGE GROUP [3]

AGE	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
20 to 24	854,382	860,773	833,569	823,537	811,988	801,917
25 to 29	859,215	855,722	837,335	825,664	811,132	797,472
30 to 34	883,303	870,082	852,939	833,957	813,585	795,521
35 to 39	873,639	868,621	867,026	859,532	846,654	830,220
20 to 39	**3,470,539**	**3,455,198**	**3,390,869**	**3,342,690**	**3,283,359**	**3,225,130**
Total	10,644,776	10,679,951	10,672,100	10,684,946	10,677,975	10,669,702
Change 20 to 39	n/a	-0.44%	-1.86%	-1.42%	-1.77%	-1.77%
Change total	n/a	+0.33%	-0.07%	+0.12%	-0.07%	-0.08%

WHAT IT MEANS FOR CORSA

- **The young core is still 3.2M+ people, enough for one flagship.**
- **Do not plan on a growing pool of young adults.**
- **Commuters and the metro area matter; there is no metro age data yet.**

HOW TO CONTINUE

a. Get metro (Jabodetabek, Greater Jakarta) age data from BPS.

b. Check which years are census data and which are projections.

c. Model visits on a flat or shrinking pool of young adults.

Note. BPS figures compiled in the research spreadsheet; the research calls the 2021 to 2026 trend projected. Averages -1.45% and +0.047% a year are the spreadsheet's; other changes and shares are computed.

Growth holds, skilled wallets shrink

WHY WE LOOKED The scope asks whether pricing can work in the local market, a core input for the Pillar 2 financial model.

THE DATA World Bank figures for Indonesia (press release and report, 16 Dec 2025) [5], with report pages as in the research. All national, not Jakarta, except Jakarta internet use; 2025 growth covers the first three quarters.

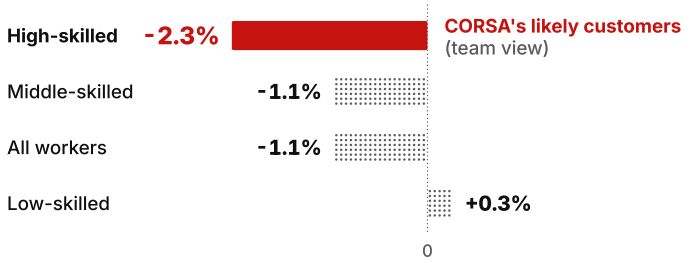
5.0%
real GDP (gross domestic product) growth, Indonesia, 2025 (first three quarters, year on year) [5]

-2.3%
a year: real wages of high-skilled workers, Indonesia, 2018 to 2024 [5]

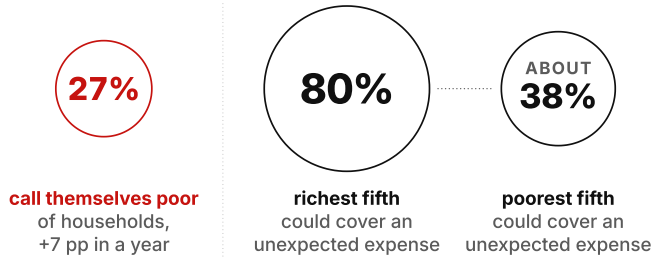
27%
of households call themselves poor (Aug 2025), +7 pp (percentage points) in a year [5]

~2%
middle-class consumption growth: households in the 40th to 90th consumption percentiles, 2023 to 2024, weaker than others [5]

REAL WAGES, % A YEAR, 2018 TO 2024 — INDONESIA, NATIONAL



Real wage growth a year, Indonesia, 2018 to 2024: total -1.1%, high-skilled -2.3%, middle-skilled -1.1%, low-skilled +0.3% [5]; high-skilled in red as closest to CORSA's customers (team view).



Aug 2025: 27% of households self-identify as poor, 7 pp more than a year earlier; 80% of the richest fifth vs about 38% of the poorest fifth can cover unexpected expenses [5].

JOBS [5]

- Employment **+1.3%** from Aug 2024 to Aug 2025: about **1.9M** net new jobs.
- Middle-skilled job share fell from **71.1%** (2018) to **68.3%** (2024).
- Under **15%** of employed 15 to 24 year olds are in formal jobs.
- A large majority of 15 to 35 year olds remain in low-tier informal work.

WAGES AND SPENDING [5]

- Real wages a year, 2018 to 2024: total **-1.1%**, middle-skilled **-1.1%**, low-skilled **+0.3%**.
- Private consumption: 2.7 pp of 2025 growth, down from 2.8 pp in 2024.
- Insecurity is particularly pronounced among self-classified middle-class households.

DIGITAL [5]

- Online in 2024: **87.8%** of Jakartans vs **72.8%** of all Indonesians.
- Digital economy 2025: **US$99bn** GMV (gross merchandise value), about **US$350** per person.
- E-commerce: about **US$71bn** in 2025.

87.8%
- of Jakartans online (2024); 72.8% nationally

US$ 99bn
- Indonesia's digital economy GMV, 2025; about US$350 per person

ABOUT US$ 71bn
- e-commerce, 2025 Indonesia, national

Internet use 2024: 87.8% in Jakarta, 72.8% nationally; digital economy 2025: US$99bn GMV, about US$350 per person, e-commerce about US$71bn [5].

WHAT IT MEANS FOR CORSA

- **Price for a squeezed skilled wallet: real wages of skilled workers are falling.**
- **Value and portion size may matter as much as the premium story (team view).**
- **Digital channels reach almost nine in ten Jakartans.**

HOW TO CONTINUE

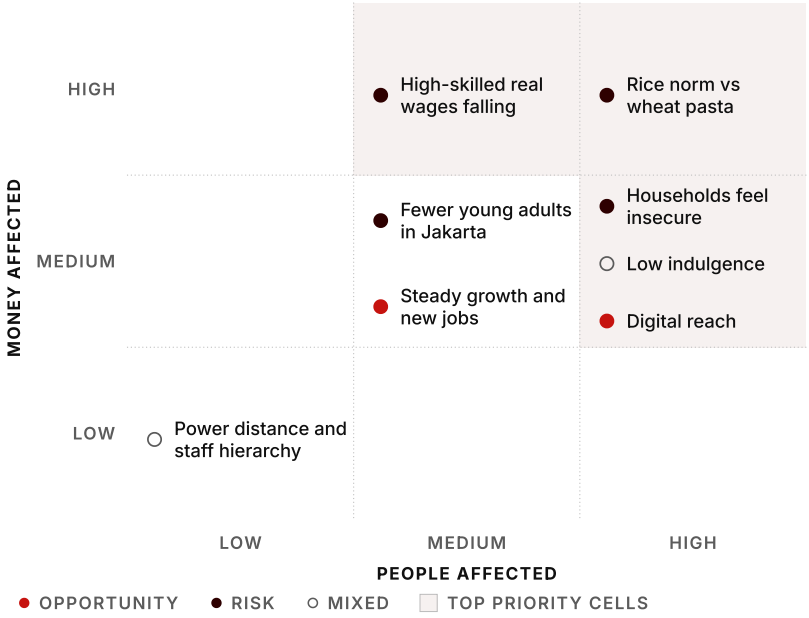
a. Find Jakarta (provincial), not national, wage data.
b. Feed the wage trend into the financial model's price assumptions.
c. Test digital promotions before launch.

Note. National data, not Jakarta, except Jakarta internet use; 2025 growth covers the first three quarters. World Bank report pages: p. 1 growth and consumption; p. 8 jobs, wages, rice; p. 9 skills, youth; p. 10 middle class; p. 11 insecurity and resilience; p. 30 internet; p. 31 digital.

Rank the risks, fill the gaps

WHY WE LOOKED Samuel asked in Meeting 4 to weigh findings by money and people affected [9], and on 7 Oct to order cultural and geographic findings by importance [10].

THE DATA The ranking is the editor's first view for discussion, not a finding of the research: it applies money affected and people affected to pages 2 to 5. Confidence shows today's evidence for each gap.



Editor's first view for discussion, not from the research: eight findings by money and people affected, the two indicators from Meeting 4 [9].

8

findings ranked by money and people affected (editor's view)

5 of 7

evidence gaps rated Weak or Missing today

22 Oct

2026 interim presentation: close the desk gaps before it

RANKING: EDITOR'S FIRST VIEW [1, 3, 5, 9]

- For discussion, not from the research: money affected x people affected.
- Top: rice norm vs wheat pasta (money High, people High).
- Then: high-skilled real wages falling (High, Medium).
- Lowest: power distance and staff hierarchy (Low, Low).

GAPS TO CLOSE [9]

GAP	DESK ACTION	CONFIDENCE TODAY
Rice norm vs wheat pasta	Indonesian data on wheat vs rice meals; Paul's open task [9]	**Weak**
Uncertainty avoidance and food trial	Survey question on trying new cuisines	**Missing**
Target group vs population (indulgence)	Survey of young professionals	**Missing**
Manila column	PSA (Philippine Statistics Authority) age tables, HDI (Human Development Index), openness	**Missing**
Jakarta metro population	Confirm the source of 35,221,231	Medium
City growth figures	Reconcile **0.32%** vs **0.047%** a year	Medium
Jakarta wages	Provincial wage data	**Weak**

WHAT IT MEANS FOR CORSA

- **The two highest risks touch the core product and the price.**
- **Both can be tested before any lease is signed.**
- **Of the seven gaps, five are desk work and two need a survey.**

HOW TO CONTINUE

a. Split the gaps between Team A and Paul now.

b. Close the desk gaps before the interim presentation on 22 October 2026.

c. FIELD WEEK, IF CONFIRMED Run the two survey questions there; date open.

Note. Money = cash flow affected; people = number of people affected (Samuel, Meeting 4 [9]). Ranking and confidence are the editor's view, not the research's.

Jakarta has scale; test culture and price first

WHY WE LOOKED For the one-page reader: what the research says, why it matters before the interim presentation on 22 October 2026, and what Meeting 4 left open [9].

THE DATA Summarises pages 1 to 6: Paul's research and this brief's own ranking and next steps, marked as such.

5 vs 79
individualism, Indonesia vs Switzerland (Hofstede index, 0 to 100) [1]

-245,409
Jakarta city residents aged 20 to 39, 2021 to 2026, projected (computed) [3]

-2.3%
a year: high-skilled real wages, Indonesia, 2018 to 2024 [5]

7 vs 5
of 14 comparison rows filled, Jakarta vs Manila (computed)

WHAT THE RESEARCH TELLS US [1, 3, 5, 6]

- Indonesia is collectivist (individualism 5) and hierarchical (power distance 78).
- The research flags the rice norm as a risk for wheat pasta.
- Jakarta city residents aged 20 to 39 shrink **1.45%** a year (2021 to 2026, projected).
- Indonesia grew **5.0%** in the first three quarters of 2025.
- High-skilled real wages fell **2.3%** a year, 2018 to 2024, nationally.
- Jakarta is bigger than Manila, Manila grows faster; most comparison cells are empty.

WHY IT MATTERS FOR CORSA

- Pillar 1, cultural fit: does the brand transfer if wheat pasta breaks a norm?
- Pillar 2: price and staff assumptions must reflect falling skilled wages and hierarchy.

LIMITATIONS

- National data stand in for Jakarta: GDP (gross domestic product), wages, consumption, insecurity, fertility.
- Hofstede scores are national averages, not Jakarta customers.
- Manila column mostly empty; Jakarta metro figure has no source.
- Two Jakarta growth figures disagree: **0.32%** vs **0.047%** a year.
- Age data partly projected; no CORSA customer has been asked yet.

WHAT TO DO NEXT [9]

- Close the desk gaps before the interim presentation on 22 October 2026.
- Get Indonesian evidence on wheat versus rice meals (Paul's Meeting 4 task).
- Feed the wage trend into the financial model's price assumptions.
- FIELD WEEK, IF CONFIRMED Add a rice or grain question; date open.

FOR THE NEXT TEAM MEETING [9]

1. Decide Manila's role: finish the column, keep a benchmark line, or drop it.
2. Agree who owns which gap: Team A or Paul.
3. Paul's collectivism data for Indonesia: what has been found so far?
4. Feed Hofstede into the CAGE (cultural, administrative, geographic, economic) cultural dimension.
5. Check the source of the Jakarta metro population figure.

USE HOFSTEDE INSIDE CAGE: WHY AND HOW [9, 10]

WHY on 7 Oct, Samuel called Paul's approach worthwhile; Matthieu, a good base.

WHY CAGE's first dimension is cultural distance, where Hofstede's scores fit.

HOW write one CAGE cultural question per relevant dimension.

HOW add the Indonesian evidence on collectivism that Paul took on in Meeting 4.

HOW set motivation aside; park long-term orientation for operations, as the research advises.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR CORSA

- **Jakarta has the scale; the open questions are cultural fit and price.**
- **Test the rice norm and the wallet before menu and price decisions.**

HOW TO CONTINUE

a. Approve the gap split and close the desk gaps before 22 October 2026.

b. Decide Manila's role: complete the column, keep a benchmark line, or drop it.

c. FIELD WEEK, IF CONFIRMED Test grain bases with young professionals; date open.

Note. Desk research only; ranking, means and next steps are this brief's view. Framework not settled: on 7 Oct Samuel said Paul should offer something better than PESTEL (political, economic, social, technological, environmental, legal) if he does not want to do PESTEL [10].

Where the numbers come from

WHY WE LOOKED Samuel asked for verified evidence [10]; [1] to [7] follow their order of appearance in the research, [8] to [10] are meeting recaps.

LINKS Every [n] in the text links here; every URL opens the source.

[1] The Culture Factor (formerly Hofstede Insights): Indonesia, Philippines, Switzerland www.theculturefactor.com/country-comparison-tool?countries=indonesia%2Cphilippines%2Cswitzerland

[2] Hofstede, G. (1991). Cultures and organizations: software of the mind (book)

[3] BPS (Statistics Indonesia) DKI Jakarta: population by age groups and sex, 2024 jakarta.bps.go.id/en/statistics-table/3/WVc0MGEyMXBkVFUxY25KeE9HdDZkbTQzWkVkb1p6MDkjMw%3D%3D/population-by-age-groups-and-sex--thousand--in-dki-jakarta-province--2024.html?year=2024

[4] Statista: fertility rate in Indonesia de.statista.com/statistik/daten/studie/252846/umfrage/fertilitaetsrate-in-indonesien/

[5] World Bank, 16 Dec 2025: Indonesia's economy maintains resilience (press release) www.worldbank.org/en/news/press-release/2025/12/16/indonesia-s-economy-maintains-resilience-amid-global-uncertainty

Added by this redesign, not in the research: World Bank Indonesia Economic Prospects page (Dec 2025 slides; full report PDF not found) www.worldbank.org/en/country/indonesia/publication/indonesia-economic-prospect

[6] PSA (Philippine Statistics Authority): population and housing psa.gov.ph/statistics/population-and-housing/node/165009?vcode=1JuCQV

[7] Statista: fertility rate in the Philippines de.statista.com/statistik/daten/studie/749036/umfrage/fertilitaetsrate-auf-den-philippinen/

[8] CORSA kickoff meeting recap, 23 Sep 2026 (internal)

[9] CORSA Meeting 4 recap, 5 Oct 2026 (internal)

[10] CORSA Market Entry Meeting recap, 7 Oct 2026 (internal)

Note. Sources [1] to [7] are those named in the research; [2] in full: Cultures and organizations: software of the mind. Intercultural cooperation and its importance for survival. [8] to [10] are internal CORSA recaps. The Jakarta metro population (35,221,231) has no source in the research: to confirm. World Bank page numbers refer to the report, not the press release. Links [3] (BPS) and [6] (PSA) show a bot check to automated tools; they should open in a normal browser.